Jacques Groenewald

HEAD OF GROWTH

Go-to-Market, Demand Generation and Revenue Systems | B2B, SaaS and eCommerce

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PROFILE

18 years in commercial roles, 11 leading growth since 2015. Growth leader who owns the whole revenue engine: positioning and offer, pricing, channels, the funnel, lifecycle and retention, and the reporting that ties spend to revenue. I have led **25+ growth and go-to-market blueprints** for SaaS, travel tech, manufacturing and services companies in the UK, US and South Africa, several of which became **fractional leadership roles**, two of them running about three years. Earlier, I managed **Microsoft's MSN and Skype advertising portfolio for Africa and the Middle East ($1.5M a month)** at Mediamark. I have hired and led teams throughout: a 10-person agency team across sales, design, development and media, and sales teams of up to 20 that I hired and trained into a national top 5.

I have also built two brands of my own from zero to R900,000+ in sales each, so I think in contribution margin, not vanity metrics. I diagnose from data first, then build hands-on: experiments, paid media, CRM, automation and AI agents. I am winding down my consulting practice to give one full-time remote leadership role my full attention.

KEY RESULTS

- **Cost per lead cut 77%** (£69 to £16) on LinkedIn for Ensinger UK, with 43 leads in 30 days.
- **Record month of R136,000 at 3.6x blended ROAS** after rebuilding an owned brand's Meta account, measured against store revenue rather than platform-reported figures.
- **Lead-to-quote system for a travel franchise:** quote preparation cut from about an hour to **2 minutes** and every lead answered in **under a minute**; 230 enquiries became 219 quotes in 30 days (95%) and 6 bookings worth R322,000, at about R32 per lead.
- **Outbound for a travel-tech SaaS (AeroCRS):** 60% reply rate, with 54% of replies booking a demo.
- **20 more sales qualified leads a week** at 20% conversion from LinkedIn outbound for an investment group, a 50% increase in two months; investor events drew 550+ registrations.

EXPERIENCE

FOUNDER-DIRECTOR, HEAD OF GROWTH

2020 - Present

JCE Media (Duel Digital (Pty) Ltd), Johannesburg | Growth consultancy

When Covid hit, pivoted the agency into a consultancy for international clients in B2B SaaS, travel tech, manufacturing, proptech, services and eCommerce (UK, US, South Africa), with a core team of an operations lead and a sales partner, plus specialist contractors.

- Created the **Seven Figure Blueprint**, a productised three-week strategy engagement (three workshops: diagnostic, ICPs, revenue leak map, offer and pricing, channel plan, money model, 90-day plan), and ran it for **25+ companies** including AeroCRS, WorldTicket, Ensinger UK and Club 720.
- Demand generation results for clients: **550+ registrations and 300 attendees** for investor events in China, New York and South Africa; **435 summit registrations** from 8,600 emails; **949 leads in 60 days at $4.78**.
- Added a **RevOps layer** to the method in 2026: maturity scoring, lead-to-revenue SLAs, sales velocity, cost-of-poor-quality costing and a quarterly operating cadence.
- Designed **CRM and lifecycle architecture** in GoHighLevel: a six-location US salon group (location segments, tour-to-lease stages, 22-email nurture), a travel franchise's WhatsApp bot and stage-triggered follow-up, and review and booking automation for hospitality clients.
- Implemented and ran **CRMs across Pipedrive, HubSpot and Zoho**: as fractional Head of Marketing Operations for Dynamic Language (translation, 200+ languages), built their Pipedrive CRM and lifted **MQL to SQL conversion 35%**; built HubSpot pipelines and reporting for Outbound Investment Group, whose LinkedIn outbound added **20 SQLs a week** at 20% conversion (+50% in two months); optimised Zoho CRM for Adept Cloud (UK); built Salesforce integrations and pulled Salesforce pipeline data into several blueprints.
- Built a **production paid-membership platform** for a four-venue pub group (Supabase, role-based access, append-only ledger, rotating redemption codes).
- Wrote the **SOPs and playbooks** that run sales and delivery: sales script, ABM outreach, cold email and follow-up, client onboarding and email campaigns.
- Ran **data diagnostics**: a five-year cohort analysis (1,184 orders) showed new-customer 90-day repeat rate falling from 38.7% to 12.3%, a R113,000-a-year leak, and set the retention fixes for the relaunch.
- Built the business's own **operating system**: action board, waiting-on register, contribution scoreboard and 25+ AI agent workflows (Claude Code, Make.com).

FOUNDER, REVIEWTAP (OWNED BRAND)

2024 - Present

Review-collection hardware and software | Johannesburg

- Built the go-to-market from zero: positioning, pricing and a volume ladder, Shopify store, paid acquisition, CRM follow-up and onboarding. **R930,000+ revenue in its first 18 months**.

- Rebuilt the Meta account into prospecting, retargeting and creative testing: **record month of R136,000 at 3.6x blended ROAS**, measured against store revenue rather than the 2.05x the platform reported.
- Mined order history and found 14+ franchise groups buying single units at retail; built a multi-site account programme and outbound that opened with each group's own order data (2 meetings and 1 yes from the first 9 contacts).

FOUNDER, MYFOREVERBABY (OWNED BRAND)

2025 - Present

Consumer eCommerce | Johannesburg

- **R919,000 gross sales in the first 14 months**, peak month R172,000, owning P&L, contribution margin and stock planning.
- Ran a controlled ad audit against first-touch store data: simple ads cost R809 per purchase at 4.35x ROAS against R1,059 at 2.23x for automated variants, and reset the account on that finding.

FRACTIONAL HEAD OF DIGITAL MARKETING

Jun 2022 - Nov 2025

Ensinger UK (engineering plastics manufacturer), via JCE Media | Remote

- Turned a 2022 Seven Figure Blueprint into a three-year role running digital for Ensinger, Elekem and Insulbar, reporting to the MD.
- Lifted contact actions **53%** (Contact Us clicks up 61%, enquiry forms up 20%) through LinkedIn and Google Search.
- Split-tested LinkedIn video ads: **CTR from 1.09% to 2.0%**, **cost per result from £2.50 to £1.30**.
- Built ABM outbound in Lemlist (1,240 invites, 5.5% reply rate), grew LinkedIn followers 32% and engagement 58% in a year, set up GA4 and Tag Manager, and handed the function in-house in Nov 2025.

FRACTIONAL HEAD OF MARKETING

Jun 2022 - Mar 2025

Club 720 and Your Housing Resource (US homeownership platform), via JCE Media | Remote

- Began with a Seven Figure Blueprint, then led growth across paid search and social, email, webinars and partner outreach.
- Reached **1,717 active users and 69 home buyer applications** in a 30-day period, with paid search driving most new users.

FOUNDER-DIRECTOR

2015 - 2020

Duel Digital, Johannesburg | Digital marketing agency (became JCE Media in 2020)

Built and led an in-house agency team of 10 (four salespeople, a designer, a developer, a media buyer, a social media manager and an executive assistant), hired every role myself, designed the sales comp plans and set the team's SLAs. We ran marketing for 40+ SMB accounts, managed **R300,000 a month in Google and Facebook ad spend**, built **400+ websites** and ran in-store activations and competitions.

PORTFOLIO MANAGER, MICROSOFT MSN AND SKYPE

Jan 2012 - Dec 2014

Mediamark (media sales house) | Africa and Middle East

- Managed Microsoft's MSN and Skype advertising portfolio for Africa and the Middle East, **worth $1.5M a month**, as commercial lead for advertisers and their agencies; grew **net revenue retention from existing clients year on year** through annual account plans.
- Sold and managed campaigns for Vodacom, Unilever, Standard Bank, Absa, Outsurance and First for Women through Omnicom and GroupM, including the **Vodacom Durban July (R5M+)**.
- Ran cross-platform campaigns that extended beyond digital to radio (Gagasi FM, Jacaranda FM, East Coast Radio), and was part of the launch of **Adfu**, Mediamark's programmatic media platform.
- Won the Hard Drive Award for top performer **five months in a row**.

SALES MANAGER

Jan 2009 - Dec 2011

Planet Fitness, Craighall and Rosebank, Johannesburg

- Hired, trained and led sales teams of up to 20 consultants across two clubs, with a structured sales process, territory planning, forecasting and pipeline discipline; both clubs hit their sales targets consistently and ranked among the **top 5 clubs in the country**.

SKILLS

GROWTH AND REVENUE:	go-to-market strategy, ICP and positioning, offer design, pricing and packaging, demand generation, paid acquisition (Google, Meta, LinkedIn), outbound and ABM, experimentation and creative testing, CRO, lifecycle and retention, P&L and contribution margin, CRM and lifecycle architecture, attribution, RevOps diagnostics (SLAs, velocity, LTV:CAC, cost of poor quality), team and agency leadership.
CRM:	HubSpot, Salesforce (integrations and reporting data), Pipedrive, Zoho CRM, GoHighLevel (API, workflows).
TOOLS:	Make.com, Shopify, Supabase, Google Analytics 4, Google Tag Manager, Search Console, Microsoft Clarity, Google Ads, Meta Ads, LinkedIn Ads, Lemlist, Klaviyo, WordPress and WooCommerce, Claude Code and AI agents, Python and Node for data work; Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint and Power BI (advanced). Also: Zapier, n8n.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BCom Management and Economics (incomplete: two modules outstanding, re-enrolling 2027), Central University of Technology.

Certified (Oct to Nov 2026): HubSpot Digital Marketing and Revenue Operations; OpenAI Academy (AI Foundations, AI Leadership, Agentic Systems, AI Application Performance); Anthropic Claude Academy (AI Fluency, Claude Enterprise, Human-Agent Teams). South African citizen, available now for UK, EU or US East Coast hours. References: Mediamark line manager; Ensinger UK's MD.